

Amazon Connect Conversational Interfaces Fundamentals

Course Summary

Concepts and terminology

DTMF IVRs: DTMF IVRs work with phone calls. Callers select predefined menu options by pressing digits on their phone keypad. These IVR systems use touch-tone or DTMF inputs. The DTMF IVRs interpret caller's menu selections through tones generated by the phone keypad. For example, a customer calling a travel company might be asked to press 1 for a new reservation, 2 to change a reservation, and 5 for all other questions.

ASR IVRs: Automatic Speech Recognition (ASR) IVR systems give callers the ability to interact using their voice. This technology uses speech recognition algorithms to analyze and interpret the caller's spoken input. The ASR IVR converts spoken words into text that the system can understand and process. However, ASR technology has limitations in handling speech variations, background noises, accents, dialects, and colloquial language.

Conversational IVRs: Conversational IVRs greet callers and listen to their statements instead of offering predefined selections. The speech recognition engine interprets the customer's spoken words and determines their intent. It provides an appropriate response or routes them to the correct self-service option. With conversational IVRs, customers can speak freely. This improves efficiency and customer satisfaction, compared to traditional DTMF IVR systems.

Benefits

Improved customer service: IVRs offer self-service options, which reduce wait times and provide continuous service. Common tasks can be self-served, so customers can get inquiries addressed whenever needed.

Scalability and multichannel support: IVRs can handle millions of conversations and scale based on demand. They provide consistent support experiences across voice, chat, websites, and mobile applications.

Enhanced agent assistance: IVRs help find the right agents for customer requests and prioritize inquiries. They reduce the need for human intervention, so agents can focus on complex tasks.

Considerations

Security: Data protection follows the AWS shared responsibility model. Organizations are responsible for securing customer data and ensuring compliance with regulations like PII.

Service quotas: AWS implements service quotas to ensure reliable service and protect against unintentional spending. Organizations can request increases for adjustable quotas to meet their needs.

Pricing: When organizations use Amazon Lex in Amazon Connect, they incur charges for both services based on their pay-as-you-go pricing models.